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Give Yourself The 'Million Dollar Marketer's Mind: How To Unleash The Idea-Power In Your Own Brain

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ADVERTISING LESSON OF THE MONTH: STOP SELLING DRILL BITS

A "SECRET" TO POWERFUL ADVERTISING. I was just working a bit with publicity-wiz Paul Hartunian on the direct-response advertising for his Course, and we had a conversation that contains a "secret" to creating the most powerful advertising possible - it is: focus on the desired end-result benefit. Sound obvious? Most mess it up. In the discussion I had with Paul, he started out focused on selling his Course based on its delivery of "millions of dollars worth of FREE advertising." But then he realized that this is not what people want. No, "free advertising" is just like drill bits. Millions are sold each year. Yet nobody wants a drill bit. These drill bit buyers want holes. In Paul's case, the end-result benefits might be...

* an awesome flood of new customers/clients/patients
* an enormous surge in profits, as you acquire your new customers without spending even a penny on advertising
* a huge, fast cash flow surge....to get out of debt, buy new equipment, etc.
* the pride of being "#1" in your business, in your community
* freedom, finally, from day-to-day worries about where your next customer is coming from
* the fun of creatively attracting customers without ordinary advertising

These benefits are achieved by the "free advertising."

So, the smart question is: ***what are the most enticing, exciting end-result benefits my customer obtains?*** Focus on the end-result, not the "thing" itself.

Let's say you sell dog obedience training. What's the end-result benefit? No - it is NOT a well-trained, well-behaved, obedient dog. No, no, no! That's still the drill bit. The end-result benefit is something like: a dog that's smarter than most people you know, that will absolutely amaze your friends and neighbors. Your friends will think you are a magician when they see the complete and total control you have over your dog.

And/or:

Now you'll be able to take your dog anywhere without worrying about him embarrassing you or acting up. Heck, take him to the opera...a black-tie dinner at the White House....church on Sunday.....or the Indianapolis 500 - without a second thought.

Sit down RIGHT NOW and make the list of END-RESULT BENEFITS people get from your product or service.

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HOW DO YOU VALUE - AND COMMUNICATE WITH YOUR CUSTOMERS?

As a business grows, and its list(s) grow, decisions must be made....customers must be ranked, Here's a sample breakdown: (Not necessarily the right breakdown for you - a sample)

A - INQUIRIES
B - ONE-TIME BUYERS
C - TWO-TIME BUYERS
D - FREQUENT BUYERS &/OR HIGH DOLLAR BUYERS
E - HYPER-RESPONSIVE BUYERS
F - CHAMPIONS

A: Inquiries are people who've requested information from you, called you, visited your store or showroom, but have not (yet) made a purchase.

B: One-time buyers have made a purchase but not responded to one or more opportunities and offers to make a second purchase.

C: Two-time buyers have made a purchase, responded to an offer and made a second purchase, but has since been unresponsive to subsequent offers.

D: Frequent buyers have bought several times and/or responded more often than not to various offers. Some businesses may replace this with a separation by total dollars spent or by size of purchase.

E: Hyper-responsive buyers respond to many offers and buy frequently. They respond to more offers than they ignore.

F: Hyper-responsives who are also very involved; they refer; they endorse, etc.

Another way to think about this is R-F-M...Recency, Frequency and Money. Your most recent buyers are usually the most likely prospects you have for another sale. Frequent buyers or hyper-responsives next most likely. And, your business may lend itself to dividing customers by the dollar amount they are willing to spend.

Finally, there are behavioral or preference categories. Customers who buy womens clothes but never buy mens, vice versa, those that buy kids clothes, those that don't.

As you can see, you might divide A list into 5, 10, even 20 categories. Then you have to think through your strategies for each group. As a very general rule of thumb, hyper-responsives and champions should hear from you most often, frequent buyers next most often. You should have a process for trying to convert inquiries to first time buyers, and another to convert first time buyers immediately to two time buyers -- the aforementioned Fingerhut is well known in direct marketing for its very aggressive, determined approach to moving one time buyers up to two time buyers. Why? From Benson's "Secrets Of Successful Direct-Mail" (which everybody ought to read!): "A two-time buyer is twice as likely to buy as a one-time buyer." You may also want an annual or bi-annual inquiry and one-time buyer list cleansing process, giving them an absolutely phenomenal offer before dropping them altogether.

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Biggest list management mistakes:

1 - "Waiting until".....you have more names, you have a computer, you have this or that. Your valid inquiry and customer names are, by far, (potentially) your most valuable asset...far more valuable than any other thing you own. But only based on the attention given. EACH name either increases or decreases in value over time. If you wait, however many names you have decrease in value.

2 - Thinking you have to be computerized to do list management. That's a lot of crap. If you are or want to be on computer, fine, go for it. But don't let the computer or lack of it serve as an excuse not to use your lists intelligently. We've managed up to 20,000 names on 33-up Avery label master sheets and done quite well that way. These days, we're using the computer, but we started and went quite a ways without it.

3 - Under-using your own lists. Just about everybody under-estimates the responsiveness and consumption capability of their own lists.

4 - Out of sight, out of mind.

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MY MARKETING SUCCESS STRATEGY FOR THE MONTH: GET OUT OF THE ALLIGATOR PIT AT LEAST AN HOUR EVERY DAY

Recently, two business partners came to visit me, looking for magical help with their host of terrible problems. Without dragging you through all the details, the bottom line: they have no terrible problems. They have a few minor problems. But, overall, they're in pretty good shape. Theirs is a business that peaked at about 2.5 million, dipped to 1.6, but is now back up to 1.8, may break 2 this year "as is", has lost some markets but gained different opportunities, and is satisfactorily if not excitingly profitable as compared to industry norms. But to hear these two, you'd think they sky was falling.

The blunt truth: they need a therapist, not a marketing consultant. Actually, they need to start with a very simple but important strategy....

One of the *Eternal Truths* that I quote in my newest book is: when you are up to your ass in alligators, it's difficult to remember that your original objective was to drain the swamp. It's easy to get so caught up in managing all the problem parts of business that you never do anything else. And that's a sure path to where these two partners are: burn-out. I could give 'em the all-time killer sales letter, the best marketing campaign ever devised, and it wouldn't do them much good...when they go to the office each day wishing they weren't there, fatigued from first thing on, going through the motions, viewing their activities as drudgery...and end the day without any sense of measurable progress toward meaningful goals...their 'walking dead' aura pervades every nook and cranny, every employee, every customer, every aspect of their business. It's the psychic equal of trying to attract a lot of customers to a restaurant that smells like rotting, burnt flesh.

Prescription: each and every day, keep a pre-set, inviolate appointment with yourself or with one or two key people, out of sight and hearing of the alligator pit, no matter how many alligators there are or how hungry they are, to do nothing but focus and work on positive, productive plans and strategies that look to the future, that are linked to goals and progress, that you can be excited and optimistic about. Simplistically, this is a means of maintaining perspective. Even better, add taking one action, getting one thing done every day, no matter what, that you know moves you forward, toward positive goals. Go home if you must knowing you spent 7 hours and 58 minutes in the alligator pit, but at least you found 2 minutes to put something in motion that will improve things.

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HOW TO MAKE A GREAT DEAL OF MONEY WITH AS LITTLE PAIN AS POSSIBLE

Now I will wax philosophic about absolutely essential business knowledge:

THE BIGGEST SINGLE MISUNDERSTANDING PEOPLE HAVE ABOUT BUSINESS SUCCESS...
THE "WRONG PATH" IT IS SO REMARKABLY EASY TO WANDER DOWN.....

As you know, I talk to a huge number of entrepreneurs-through Guthy-Renker, through referrals, seminars, consulting, my Subscribers, people are arriving by FAX, mail, phone, UPS and in person daily, most eager to regale me with every nitty-bitty detail of their incredible product or product idea....

Sometimes I listen patiently.

And I groan inwardly, as I listen to these people so into their particular product, so enthused with their product, so convinced it is one-of-a-kind, so profoundly committed to its unique ability to stand out in the marketplace...

Because all of that is incidental to the issues we should be talking about. Like: who was it built for? What evidence is there that they will spend money for it? What media and marketing method lends itself to the situation? Because:

Jeff Paul called me at 9:00 PM my time the other night, understandably excited by the succinct way to explain this to people, that he had just found in an old advertising book he'd bought in an antique store-the quote said:

ANY FOOL CAN MAKE SOAP. IT TAKES A CLEVER MAN TO SELL IT.

There is the wisdom of the ages. There is a million dollar quote.

It's so hard to accept. The lady-psychologist sends me the cassette program she's lovingly, painstakingly put together about successful parenting - and she does NOT want to think of that as "soap." She believes, maybe rightly so, that it is different and better than any book, any tape, any anything that has ever been put together about parenting. But there's two things she doesn't want to get: one, I've got 11 other products just like hers piled up in a corner of my office, from 11 other people who believe just as passionately that there is the only/best doohickey on parenting ever invented. And over in Palm Desert, Cindi Anderson at Guthy-Renker has 9 more. And down in Key West, in Gary's office, there are 14 others. And on and on and on. Darn it, it is "soap." Second, more importantly, even if it is the best, the most innovative, the most technologically advanced, the best researched, the most credible, etc., etc., etc. none of that matters one whit if nobody will buy the damned thing. They will only appreciate all that if and after they buy it. And the truth is that any psychologist, many other authors, coaches, teachers, ministers and parents can "make" this particular "soap." It takes a clever person to sell it.

Now, the next tough idea to accept: the time to think about who it will be sold to and how it will be sold to them is BEFORE you build it, not afterward.

You cannot imagine how many people arrive with their "soap" and no money left to promote it. "But I spent all my money making it," they cry, "I though somebody else'd jump at the chance to put up all the money to sell it." Please let me dis-abuse that idea. If I wanted to sell "soap," I wouldn't invest my

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money in selling your "soap" and make you rich; I'd hire some "soap-maker" for a pittance to make "soap" for me. If I wanted to sell a course on parenting, I'd run a little ad in Writers Digest, Psychology Today, the National Writers Club newsletter, etc., have my choice of a blue-zillion experts and writers, and pay one a few thousand bucks, at the most, and maybe, maybe, maybe a teeny little royalty to create that course just for me. And that applies to anything and everything.

"Hey, that means he'll steal MY idea." Nuts to you. That's not the point. The point is I don't need to steal your idea for "soap"; I've already heard it 100 times before you got here.

The person who DOES get his "soap" promoted in a big way brings marketing assets to the table with the soap. The skin care product maker shows up WITH Victoria Principal in her pocket. The author with the course on parenting comes in with a nationally syndicated radio show, a contact at Sally Jesse Raphael. The guy with the golfing thingamajig has access to a list of 135,000 golf newsletter subscribers. Etc.

At the very least, the smart entrepreneur does research and builds a case for the successful marketing of "soap" BEFORE making "soap."

Before investing a year of your life putting together your whiz-bang course on parenting, how about finding out whether anybody has ever sold an audio-course, a video, a newsletter or a seminar on parenting to parents - other than a book in bookstores - and, if so, who, how many, at what price, and how. Now, what do those buyers "look like?" What were they willing to spend? How can they be reached? Let me tell you something about blazing an entirely new trail: you get eaten up by the lions, fall off a cliff, or killed by Injuns.

Here's yet another powerful marketing lesson:

A BUYER IS A BUYER IS A BUYER....BUT
SOMEONE WHO WON'T BUY, WON'T BUY.

If you want to sell your "soap," find an economically sensible way to reach people who have bought other kinds of "soap" before, and have bought different kinds repetitively.

OK, YOU'VE IGNORED ALL THIS ADVICE AND
BUILT SOME DARNED PRODUCT YOU'RE IN LOVE WITH,
MARRIED TO AND IN DEBT WITH. NOW WHAT?

You've just got to find buyers. When you find one, you've got to learn as much as possible about that creature, so you can try and find more of 'em.

The buyer for a Mercedes is every different than the buyer for a Pontiac Sunbird. This industry idiotically talks to everybody about their products. But if you're starting from scratch, with little resources, you'd better not do THAT. If you've got a "Mercedes," you'd better find out exactly who will buy it. Then find out where people just like him are. Do they all live in one place? Do they all read one magazine? Do they all go to a particular restaurant? Do they all shop at the same mall? You see, you can ONLY afford to communicate with those people who are precisely matched to and already proven likely to buy a Mercedes.

Going back to the person who invests life and limb in creating her course on parenting. If she's given any thought to marketing at all, she has statistics. She'll say: "There are x-# parents of kids between age a and b."

Great. Unfortunately, the overwhelming majority of those parents don't give a rat's behind about being better parents. Some think they know it all. Some think their kids are screwed up, but they're ok. Most don't think at all. Some are dead broke. Some functionally illiterate. And I could go on.

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Somewhere in all that, there is a miniscule percentage who are literate, open-minded, concerned, self-improvement oriented, and have already demonstrated their willingness to invest time and money in being better parents. But if you have to wade through all the muck to find 'em, you will run out of gas long before you get there.

"But there are millions who NEED my product." Terrific. Want to get me excited? Show me how many have previously, preferably repetitively, demonstrated their ability and willingness to invest in their desire for products like yours. Then show me that we can find and reach them. Now we got something. Now I can help you.

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Article Reprint: A New Marketing Strategy For Today: ETHICS! (by Dan Kennedy)

A cartoon shows a group of suit-and-tie attired businessmen clustered around a conference table, the proverbial sales chart with the downard aimed red arrow at one end, and the meeting leader saying: "Ethics? Smythe, we'll talk about ethics as soon as we can afford to talk about ethics!"

Sadly, this is all to often the actual attitude of business leaders and entrepreneurs, as a result of a very simple misunderstanding.

In my business seminars, I'll often ask participants to quickly make a list, on their yellow pads, of the most important assets of business. "Think about getting ready to go to the bank," I tell them, "to discuss loan extensions or other credit matters, then prepare your asset recap." When they share their lists, just about everybody lists such things as buildings, real estate or long-term leases as desirable locations; equipment and technology, inventory, copyrights and trademarks...and most completely forget to include what I insist is the single most important asset of all - the customers!

Incidentally, insurance will replace most other assets, but the only insurance against loss of customers is exceptional service, which is a practical application of a high ethical standard.

Double Your Business, Fast

Most of the business owners and managers I interact with are most eager for advice to stimulate and increase sales, and most see the 'solution' to that 'question' as: new customers. They want to know how to get more new customers.

New customer acquisition is very expensive. For most businesses, it requires capital investment and risk. After all, advertising and marketing is only partly scientific; there is always risk of loss.

Most businesses can, instead, at least double their sales without adding a single new customer. The increases are readily available within their own present and past customer base.

I recently attended a marketing conference where it was revealed that the majority of American corporations place their "customer service functions" under "operations" not under "marketing," thus viewing it as a cost of operations, pure expense item, rather than an investment in marketing - and this is dumb! Customer retention via customer service has to be seen as a profit center in a business. The savvy marketer, who will survive whatever impact the current recessions has on his industry and/or locale and who will prosper in the future, places great importance on the asset 'the customer' and seeks to maximize their "Total Customer Value."

Consider that there can be three basic 'categories' of ethical standards in relationships between business and its customers.

1) Minimum Ethic: We will do just enough to comply with all laws, stay out of jail, and deter lawsuits or returns for refunds.

Several years ago, at a seminar, on a dare, I made a list of ten known companies, in diverse industries, all viewed as "healthy" at the time that I predicted would be bankrupt within two years. My list was made up of businesses I believed were operating via this minimum standard. Two years later seven of the ten were bankrupt and an eighth had been acquired while on the verge of bankruptcy. Just recently, one of the two remaining companies who beat my prediction announced first-quarter losses of 130-million dollars, massive employee layoffs, and, obviously is in danger.

2) Average Ethics: we will give the customer "fair exchange" - reasonable value for their dollars, no less, but no more. Truthfully, most businesses are here. And, as a result, during good times, they'll get average results, and will generally turn a profit and stay in business.

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3) Maximum Ethics: to paraphrase another Kennedy, we ask not how we can get more sales, we ask how we give more and better service! This is the right question. The business owner who is constantly striving to better reward his customers for their patronage is taking the ethical high ground, and will be amply rewarded.

This means many things. Truth in advertising and selling is one of those things. To many marketer's surprise, it's easier to sell and satisfy when you present an honest picture of the benefits and the drawbacks of a product or service than when you paint an overwhelmingly rosy picture! Why? Well, people are more skeptical than ever before and are rightfully suspicious of anything that seems too good to be true. Most customers appreciate honesty. Sellers do a better job when they know they are behaving ethically. In fact, a major cause of retail sales clerk apathy and ineffectiveness as well as of field sales representatives' failure is their unhappiness at being involved in what they feel is an unethical selling situation. Staff performance is always improved by a business' leadership's passionate commitment to maximum ethics.

There's no mystery here. You and your staff need to brainstorm how you would like to be treated, if you were your customer. Compile the longest, most detailed list you can of ideas about how you would most appreciate being treated and keep to the list.

And if you run out of ideas, start looking around at the 'opposite' delivered by most other clerks who know nothing about the store's merchandise. I'd suggest to you that staffing a store with uninformed, poorly trained people is an unethical act.

It's worth noting, too, that the ethics employed in relationships between a business' leaders and its employees finds its way to the customer, too. Grossly underpaid or otherwise abused employees, who cannot strike back at management, vent their resentments on the customers. It's instructive that the quality of American made automobiles only stopped declining and started improving when the manufacturers began emphasizing improving employee relations and employee involvement in decision-making.

There are many good reasons for ethical standards and behavior in business. Peace of mind is one of them. Depending on spiritual beliefs, your seating assignment in the afterlife might be another. If no other reason motivates you, you might consider its value as plain, simple, good business.

(Source: Buy-Line, Published by Wal-Mart Stores, Inc., Fall 1991)

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Article Reprint From PHILOSOPHY OF SUCCESS MAGAZINE on Successful Marketing Strategies For Any Business

The printing company's truck backed up to our warehouse door, loaded with about a hundred cartons of brochures for one of our companies. The driver got a pushcart out of the back, and asked where we wanted him to take the boxes to. Following our directions, he wheeled the cart full of boxes through our warehouse area and into a back office.

"Just pile them over there." I said. "We have to separate them by the title of the brochures packed inside before putting them on the shelves."

"I've already done that for you." the driver said. "And these boxes are labled with the different titles right here on the side, to make it easier for you to access the right boxes." He then proceeded to put the boxes in the right places on the shelves.

Then, as he left the building, he closed the warehouse door behind him.

And, incidentally, he thanked us for our business.

I don't know if this surprises you or not, but that's MARKETING! I'll tell you this: this experience was a lot different than our experiences with most vendors' delivery people. **This** driver was courteous. **This** deliveryman did more than was required of him. **This** deliveryman let us know that our business was appreciated.

Common courtesies, you say. Unfortunately, these courtesies are not very common at all. In fact, they're extremely rare. And it's worth noting that our society, our marketplace, prizes that which is rare most.

This particular experience with this particular deliveryman may have been accidental. He may just be a naturally pleasant, considerate, helpful fellow. Or he may have taken it upon himself, for some unknown reason, to develop a pleasing personality, and to practice good customer relations.

But, if this is an accident, it is a great example of an accident that should be repeated on purpose, as a marketing strategy.

What is Marketing?

Most people expect a column in a magazine on "marketing" to address such subjects as advertising, direct-mail, increasing customers' purchasing, stimulating referrals, finding a market niche, and so on. And you won't be disappointed: in future issues of THE PHILOSOPHY OF SUCCESS MAGAZINE, in this column, I will be addressing those topics and others like them. Specific methods and strategies that virtually any type of business can use to attract more customers/clients, and to do more business with the customers/clients they have.

But in this 'premiere column,' I want to let you know that **everything you think of as something other than marketing is actually marketing.**

For example, most businseses think of **maintenance** as **maintenance**. The Disney parks think of **maintenance** as **marketing**, because the remarkable cleanliness of the parks is a major stimulant of positive word-of-mouth advertising. What aspects of your business aren't thought of as marketing but should be thought of as marketing, and re-worked as marketing strategies?

QUALITY is certainly one of them. Product quality. Service quality. "IN SEARCH OF EXCELLENCE' author Tom Peters jokes about the retail executive who became aggravated at Peter's criticism of his industry in a seminar, and cried out, "We are no worse than anybody else." Peters had a graphic artist design a company logo with the slogan in it: we are no worse than anybody else.

Quality must be developed as a marketing strategy, because no other marketing strategies can build and sustain a business without it.

Another aspect of business often overlooked as a marketing strategy is courtesy.

Courtesy can be expressed many different ways. Like the deliveryman taking time to sort the boxes. Or the Horschow mail-order company sending each item ordered during the holiday season in a beautiful Christmas-green gift-

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box, with a gold elastic ribbon, and a gift card, all at no extra cost. Or the Figi's Company, a mail-order marketer of gourmet foods and gifts, sending a personalized letter acknowledging receipt of an order and reassuring the customer that it will be shipped on time. Or the Doctor who calls his patient at home, the evening after treatment, just to "check on him." Or, even with a simple "think you."

It's an important marketing principle: people want most what they have the least of. Today, somewhat sadly, the things most people get the least of are recognition and appreciation.

Gratitude As A Marketing Strategy

Several years ago, I took over a business with mammoth colleciton problems: almost all of its customers had open-accounts and paid their bills ten to sixty days late (except those who didn't pay at all). We quickly instituted a number of corrective measures, including tighter credit controls and policies, interest charges, a sequence of past-due notices, and collection calls. However, we also implemented a positive strategy. We started sending hand-signed thank-you notes for prompt payment to anybody who did pay on time...those who were almost on time...and even late-payers who responded to a past-due notice. Guess what happened? Those customers who received thank-you notes became better paying customers.

I know a Doctor who started a procedure of giving fresh, long-stemmed red roses to his women patients who showed up for their appointments on time, or paid their bills on time, or referred another patient. "Funny thing," he told me. "We no longer have patients missing appointments. Our collections have improved. Referrals are up. And, some guys are starting to ask how they can get roses, too!"

Here are a few specific ideas you might adopt, as ways of saying thank you:

* Keep customers' birthdays on file, and send cards and/or small gifts.
* Send Thanksgiving cards or letters.
* Make it a habit to drop a personal thank-you note in the mail each day, to at least one customer.
* Send a gift certificate or discount certificate to a customer who makes an unusually large purchase.
* Host a "Customer Appreciation Event" - a Christmas party, a backyard bar-b-que.
* Have an occasional closed-to-the-public, preferred customer sale.
* Drop in personally on your best customers, with a surprise gift.

I figured it up just the other day; in 1986, personally and for my various businseses combined, I signed checks for well over one million dollars, in payment for goods and services to all sorts of people and companies. And I don't care what anybody says - a million bucks is a lot of money. Yet, I can count on the fingers of one hand the number of the recipients of all that money who've expressed any gratitude in any formal kind of way. Only one of them found out about and recognized my birthday.

Just saying "thanks" is a big step ahead of the competition today.

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Article Reprint From THE PHILOSOPHY OF SUCCESS MAGAZINE on Successful Marketing Strategies for Any Business

Genius is sometimes defined as the ability to make the complex simple. Certianly, "marketing" is a complex subject; so complex it's very difficult for many business people to ever get a handle on it. Its complexity is intimidating. After years in "marketing," I've finally found a definition of "marketing" that reflects the genius of simplicity. ***MARKETING is simply making the right presentation of the right message to the right people.***

With that simple definition as a guide, just about every businessperson can clearly see his past errors, and do a more effective job of marketing in the future.

Let's talk about the right people first. Many salespeople and business owners have dramatically unsuccessful experiences with direct-mail and with tele-marketing for this simple reason: they're mailing to or calling the wrong people! Who are the right people? Prospects who most closely match the demographics of your good, established customrs and/or your desirable customers. "Demographics" refers to statistical, lifestyle and preference information about people.

The best way to explain it is through example:

Let's say you've got a restaurant, a small retail store of some kind or a service business - maybe a hairstyling salon. Your business is doing well, but could do much better. A good first step in seeking new customers would be to find out as much as possible about your existent customers, in search of demographics that might help you in the pursuit of new customers. For example, you might discover that the majority of your customers live within an x-mile radius of your place of business. Or, you might discover that the majority of your customers drive late-model compact cars...have MasterCards and VISA Cards...subscribe to a certain magazine...are between the ages of 25 and 40...are married. Armed with this information, you can obtain a mailing list, or compile a mailing list, of prospects who closely match the characteristics shared by the majority of your customers. You might, for example, get a mailing list of all the subscribers to FAMILY CIRCLE MAGAZINE, who are between the ages of 25 and 40 and who live within a 50-mile radius of your business. Is such a list available? You bet! You might get another list of MasterCard and VISA cardholders, who are married and live within a 50-mile radius of your business. This is generally called LIST SELECTION and many direct marketing experts believe it to be the single, most important factor in success or failure with a direct marketing campaign. I happen to agree, and firmly believe that money spent in obtaining the best possible list is more than recovered via savings on printing quantities (in direct-mail) and via improved response.

If you are unfamiliar with the availability of mailing lists and with list selection, you should begin your education with a visit to the main public library in your area, to study a huge directory: ***Standard Rate And Data Service (SRDS)***. This directory provides detailed information on tens of thousands of available mailing lists and list suppliers. In your local Yellow Pages, you'll also find list brokers under the category "Mailing Lists." You should meet with several of these people before choosing to do business with one of them. You may also want to deal with national list brokers. There are a number of long-established, reputable list brokers and many of them publish catalogs of the lists they own and/or represent.

You can also compile your own list for many purposes, from local telephone directors, a "Criss-Cross Directory" that lists people by geographic area or membership directories of certain clubs or organizations. And, still another list compilation method, suitable for small businesses, is through inexpensive classified advetising. I know an attorney, for example, who has this ad running continually in the "business opportunity section" of his local newspaper:

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"Before you buy a business, obtain free consultation on legal issues you need to consider.
Also: specialized assistance for the small business person with
contracts, incorporations, partnerships, buy-sell agreements, etc.
Call for FREE BOOKLET:
THE SMALL BUSINESSMAN'S LEGAL QUESTION AND ANSWER GUIDE."

He gets at least a dozen calls, every week, requesting his free booklet. These people are placed on his mailing list and receive letters and other information from his office, periodically, over a period of time. Eventually, over half of them come in for initial consultations and, again, more than half of these become clients. There are many different businesses that could adapt this idea to their needs.

So, our first of the three steps to success in direct marketing is targeting the right people to receive the message. In the next issue of PHILOSOPHY OF SUCCESS MAGAZINE, we'll tackle the second step: developing the right message.

I also want to encourage you to use your own customer list as a mailing list, more often and more effectively. Most business people "miss the boat" by failing to maintain frequent contact with their customers. For one thing, it's important to remember that someone who has purchased from you once, and been satisfied, is then predisposed to purchase from you again. Second, you do have competition to be concerned about, so there is a need to stay on the top of your customer's consciousness - after all, out of sight; out of mind. Third, frequently communicating with customers is an appreciated form of "extra mile service."

Here are a few ideas for communications with customers:

FOR ALMOST ANY BUSINESS:

* A News-And-Idea Letter
* Seasonal Greetings
* Thank You Letters

FOR RETAILERS:

* Preferred Customer Sale Flyers
* Letters introducing new products, product lines

FOR SERVICE BUSINESSES AND PROFESSIONALS:

* Reminder Notices of service dates
  (time for a dental checkup; time for an oil change, etc.)
* Informative booklets or reports

It's been my experience that most businesses' repeat sales can be doubled simply by making additional, more frequent contact and offers to established customers!

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Article Reprint From PHILOSOPHY OF SUCCESS MAGAZINE on Successful Marketing Strategies For Any Business

In our last article, we defined MARKETING as *"making the right presentation of the right message to the right people."* Then we discussed how to determine who the right people are to contact for your particular business. This month, let's tackle the right message.

"The right message" will include everything that a customer or client of your type of business or user of your type of goods or services traditionally expects plus an added Unique Selling Proposition.

The customer or client already expects certain things from your business. If you operate a car dealership, for example, he expects you to have a showroom, an inventory of automobiles, salespeople, competitive prices, financing, and a service department. If you operate a restaurant, the customer expects you to have a clean, pleasant facility, menus, daily specials, waiters and waitresses, good food. If you're an insurance agent, your client expects you to offer a full range of insurance plans and policies, competitive rates, personalized service, prompt handling of claims and knowledgeable advice. Whatever your business, there are certain things that your prospective customer or client expects of you.

Your message has to affirm the existence of these expected things. It is a mistake to take anything for granted; to assume that the prospect will assume that you have them. Instead, *"you should put forth your complete sales message every time you deliver any message at all."* You cannot predict what information may be of prime importance to a given prospect at a given time, so you must present all the relevant information all the time.

Here's one example. I travel quite a bit, and often conduct evening seminars that end around 10:00 PM. I'm interested in finding a restaurant that serves dinner late in the evening and accepts American Express - those are the two pieces of information of prime interest to me. Eight out of ten times, one or both of these pieces of information is omitted from restaurants' Yellow Pages advertising. Of course, someone else may have a bias for family-owned and operated restaurants. A true Italian food lover wants to know if the pasta is homemade. The restaurant's message, then, needs to cover all of these bases, and many more.

In other words, the right message is a complete message. The more you tell, the more you sell! So the first step in creating a compelling sales message is to develop a comprehensive "master list" of every fact, feature and benefit of your product, service or business you can think of. Don't be judgemental; list everything you can possibly think of.

Here are some examples of marketers who have erred by omission:

A supermarket has "bag boys" take every customer's groceries to the car and place them in the trunk, but never mentions this in its advertising. A manufacturer I recently consulted with guarantees on-time shipment or the order is free, but this policy appears only in fine print on the contracts. A restaurant has a relish tray and dessert included with all its meals, but never tells anybody until they get there. A car wash "Armor-Alls" the tires, dashboards, door panels and vinyl tops of all the cars as a matter of routine, but never mentions this in its advertising. In each of these cases, I asked the owners of these businesses: "Why don't you talk about this in your marketing?"

The answers I got were:

* "Gee, we never thought about it."
* "The customer expects it anyway."
* "It's no big deal."

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* "My competitor does it, too."

Here are my answers:

* You have to think about it! Leave no stone unturned in developing a complete marketing message.

* How do you know what the customer expects? And even if he does expect it, shouldn't you let him know that he's right?

* You can't possibly judge what is and isn't a "big deal" to your customers. You think differently than they do.

* Your competitor isn't telling anybody either.

So, ***Step One: develop a complete marketing message. Step Two: tailor the message to your market.*** You've selected certain prospective customers or clients, based on demographics. That means that you know quite a bit about those people. That means you can organize your message to place greatest emphasis on the things most likely to be of the greatest interest to those people.

Let's use the restaurant as an example. If you mail to people who are Diners Club members, then the fact that your restaurant accepts Diners Club is a very important part of your message. It deserves priority. You might even use it as the opening gambit in your mailing, i.e. "Dear Diners Club Member. There's a new dining experience waiting for you tonight!" On the other hand, if you're mailing to young marrieds who live in "starter homes" near your restaurant, your acceptance of Diners Club is a much less important item. It still belongs in your complete marketing message: some of the prospects may have a Diners Club card. But there are other parts of your message much more deserving of emphasis to these prospects.

Step Three: add a "Unique Selling Proposition." This is the final factor that differentiates your business, product or service and marketing message from every other similar competitor. It is the answer to this challenging question: *"Why should I call you/come to you/buy from you instead of anyone else in your business anywhere?"* I'll admit this IS one tough question. But if you can't come up with a good answer for it, I'd suggest thinking about getting into a different business.

Here are a few idea-starter examples of Unique Selling Propositions:

* Lucky Supermarkets claims to have "lowest prices overall," and documents the claim by comparing register tapes for assortments of groceries.

* Federal Express promises delivery by 10:30 AM next day, or no charge.

* America West Airlines advertises "Less Fare, More Care." They then compete with the budget pricing of discount airlines, but provide free drinks, copies of The Wall Street Journal, and other amenities.

* Dominos Pizza delivers in 30 minutes or the pizza's free. Pizza Hut used the same basic promise with their lunch pizzas.

* A dentist promises "after your first visit, your child will not argue, cry or otherwise give you a hard time about coming to the dentist."

* A furniture chain advertisies its "no money miracle" - no payments for six months after purchase.

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When you have a good, strong Unique Selling Proposition, the development of a compelling marketing message and the use of that message in advertising, direct-mail and other forms of promotion becomes easy. Without a Unique Selling Proposition, marketing is difficult.

There is one warning warranted about your marketing message: don't promise what you cannot or will not deliver. Businesses that lack this integrity almost inevitably fail. It may take a while, but they fail.

Each dissatisfied customer can do irreparable, huge damage to your business. Some research I've seen indicates that the average satisfied customer tells 3 people about his experience while the average dissatisfied customer gripes to 11 other people. That ratio obviously can destroy a business.

How do dissatisfied customers develop? The **#1 Cause** of dissatisfied customers is a significant breach between the promise of the marketing message and the reality of the product and/or service. Then, the **#2 Cause** is an apparent lack of concern on the business' part when a complaint is registered about this breach.

As some of you who follow my writings and recordings are well aware, I had a major altercation with the previously mentioned America West Airlines, over a damaged piece of luggage. This incident and lack of responsible reaction to it by America West's people was all the more irritating, of course, because of its juxtaposition to the "more care" selling proposition.

To be fair, I want to now acknowledge that a copy of the Cassette and my correspondence finally reached Mr. Edward Beauvais, the CEO of America West Airlines, and he demonstrated that he was, in fact, very concerned with passenger service and satisfaction. He took responsible remedial action, including replacing my damaged Hartman with a brand new one at the airline's expense. As it should be. The unfortunate fact remains that, at least up until now, his willingness to accept responsibility for his company's errors: his desire to preserve passenger good-will; his integrity; even his good common sense has not filtered down through the ranks of his organization. The incident with me only cost his airline a few thousand dollars in lost revenue during the dispute and the price of a suitcase. However, the long term failure to match the reality of service with the advertised promises could cost the airlines millions of dillars, if not its very life. If there are desirable benefits from selling "more care," then everyone must accept the responsibility of delivering "more care," because the customers who buy the "more care proposition" then expect more than they otherwise would have.

No marketing message is strong enough to overcome a disappointing reality over an extended period of time!

For that reason, I urge you to view "customer relations" as positive, productive, profitable marketing - not, as so many businesses do, as a costly necessary evil or worse as a "buzzword" to be tossed about lightly. I highly recommend the following helpful materials: Frank Cooper's book titled *THE CUSTOMER SIGNS YOUR PAYCHECK*, and Jerry Wilson's audio cassette *HOW TO BUILD CUSTOMER LOYALTY AND WATCH SALES SOAR!*

In the next Issue of PHILOSOPHY OF SUCCESS MAGAZINE we'll complete the successful marketing equation with the keys to the right presentation.

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In the two previous Columns, in the two previous Issues of Philosophy Of Success Magazine we defined MARKETING as "making the right presentation of the right message to the right people." We've already discussed how to find the right people and how to create the right message; now we need the right presentation to complete the marketing formula.

The marketing media used to deliver the presentation can differ dramatically. It might be a sales letter, a direct-mail package, a newspaper or magazine ad, a TV commercial, a telephone call, an in-person sales call, a group presentation (seminar), a brochure, a catalog, etc. But regardless of which media you use to deliver a presentation, there are certain keys to making it as effective as possible.

THE FIRST KEY is that the presentation has to be well-organized. People have to be led through the presentation in a prepared, thought-out, step-by-step manner. You'll have to decide, for example, whether or not you first have to establish the need before even beginning to sell your product or service. A company selling dog food doesn't have to do this. If they are talking to dog owners (the right people) about a superior quality, vitamin-fortified, discount-priced dog food (the right message), they can leap right into presenting that dog food. On the other hand, a company selling an alarm-device that goes off when someone -- such as a child -- goes in your backyard swimming pool may be talking to swimming pool owners (the right people) with a persuasive argument about this great device, offered with free installation and 12-month no-interest financing (the right message), but might have to start by discussing statistics concerning accidental drownings in swimming pools, risks of lawsuits, etc. before even selling their device. You have to think through a step-by-step order for your presentation.

THE SECOND KEY is that the presentation has to be understandable. One of the most common errors made in marketing is over-estimating the intelligence and sophistication of the customer, client or prospect.

A brilliantly planned and delivered presentation full of jargon and buzz words unique to your business, vocabulary unfamiliar to your prospects, difficult concepts, complex math or long, complex sentences (like this one) will not get desireable results. The *confused* person does not buy. The *frightened* person does not buy. In most cases, the *intimidated* person does not buy. The marketer has to relate to his customers at their actual level of thinking, not the level he thinks they think at!

Most of us have illusions -- dangerous illusions -- about the sophistication of our clientele. It's actually flattering to me to believe that my clientele is smarter than "average," isn't it? In this case, that kind of self-flattery can be fatal. To create the right presentation, you really have to get a *feel* for your prospects and customers. Go drive around in their neighborhoods, eat where they eat, shop where they shop, read what they read, and so on. To use IN SEARCH OF EXCELLENCE terminology, *get close to the customer!*

Here's a great lesson about putting together the right presentation in retailing by being close to the customer. At Stew Leonard's super-supermarket, they were bringing in fresh fish every day, carefully packaging it, and putting it in the freezer cases, labeled as "fresh fish." They had the right message (people who like fish really like fresh fish); they had the right people (many of their customers are upscale consumers who have the money to buy fresh fish, the time and inclination to prepare a meal with it, and an appreciation of it), but for many of their customers they had the wrong presentation. One of their customers told them that she wished they had *real* fresh fish, like at the fish markets --- laying there on a slab of ice. Stew Leonard and his people divided the fresh fish that came in each day in half and **presented the same fish two different ways:** one, as they had been,

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packaged; two, unpackaged, on a slab of ice, in a little food display unit labeled "Fish Market." Guess what? Their sales of fresh fish more than doubled!

THE THIRD KEY is that the presentation has to be interesting, even exciting and dramatic. Whatever you do in marketing, don't be boring! Your presentation has to make it fun for your customer to buy. It has to make it impossible for him to ignore it. It has to so captivate his curiosity and interest that he can't turn away from it until he's read or heard every word.

I just saw a new TV-commercial for a high-fiber cereal that is really dramatic. The man is sitting reading a newspaper, I think the WALL STREET JOURNAL. He lays it down on the table, folded to an article, looks at his wife, and in a very serious voice quietly says, **"We've been killing ourselves."** Now are you going to turn away from that? Don't you have to wait and see what these ordinary looking people have been doing to themselves? My God - maybe we've been doing the same horrible thing to ourselves!

THE FOURTH KEY is that your presentation has to demand action. I don't care if you are selling in person, in print or on television, you cannot afford to be subtle. You've got to tell the person exactly what you expect him to do, how to do it and when to do it.

Too much marketing is *wimpy*. It stops short of demanding any action. Here's our beautiful new car -- but never: now come on down to the showroom, plop your rear-end in its driver's seat, and test drive the darned thing this Saturday from 9 to 4 and get a free case of Pepsi. Here's our wonderful new product -- but never: now go to your phone, dial our toll-free number, and get a free sample sent to you along with $5 in coupons.

When you combine these 4 keys to Presentation with the other marketing ideas already covered, you'll have a marketing formula that gets great results every time!

In the next column, I'll introduce you to several of the greatest direct-marketing campaigns ever used, and how you can apply the ideas to your business.

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In previous issues of this column, we've defined "marketing" as "making the right presentation of the right message to the right people." In the Cassette Program I recently completed: Successful Direct Marketing Strategies For Any Business, I used an advertisement for a restaurant in the Lady Luck Casino as a perfect example of this definition in action. Now this same entity, the Lady Luck Casino, has done it again and deservedly won the 1987 Silver Echo Award for Newspaper/Magazine Traffic Building. Examining their award-winning and successful traffic-building strategy provides a great object lesson for anyone with a retail store, hotel, restaurant, beauty salon or any other business where attracting new customers is important.

The Lady Luck is not located on the famous Las Vegas Strip and it had an ad budget of only $37,000.00. Somehow, it needed to use this comparatively small mound of ammunition to compete with the giant hotels' colorful, glamorous, neon advertising. Most of the Lady's competitors run beautiful, full-color, full-page newspaper and magazine ads featuring glamorous chorus girls, famous celebrities and striking photographic montages. With only $37,000.00 to spend for the year, matching that approach was "out."

First, the Lady's marketers carefully researched which airlines fly the most tourists to Las Vegas. This was an exercise in finding the most cost-effective media possible for reaching "the right people."

Second, a half-page, horizontal ad was created that was the dramatic opposite of other casinos' advertising: it had no photos, no girls, no color; only 460 words of copy and the headline: "WIN - OR YOUR MONEY BACK!" This editorial approach was "the right presentation"; guaranteed winning represented "the right message." (The actual message is centered around each customer's opportunity to take a "pull" on a special slot machine and either win a big prize or get his money back.)

Did this work? You bet! Every objective set was beat: in five months, the projected response was exceeded by 174%; an additional 5,192 airline-magazine readers requested the coupon book advertised; cost per response was reduced by 82% compared to previous, more conventional advertising; and $535,475.00 in directly measureable revenue was generated. For every dollar invested, $14.32 was returned.

There are a number of lessons to be learned from all this. Here are a few:

1) Direct marketing is often the best method of presentation, even for businesses that do not customarily use direct marketing. Every business owner can benefit from learning about direct marketing.

2) Contrarian marketing often out-performs copycat marketing. If everybody, in a given business, seems to be using a particular method of attracting customers, there are two reasonably certain conclusions that can be arrived at as a result. First, that the method is working, at least for those who started it, who have now been copied by so many others that it's an obvious trend. Second, it is being worn out rapidly and its effectiveness will diminish in the future. When you come in as a copycat marketer, chasing an already developed trend, you are more likely to lose than to profit. Often, you can create the next new trend by doing the opposite of what your competitors are doing.

3) Success in marketing begins with the step most are too lazy to do - quality research. The cost of good research is an investment that almost always pays big dividends down the road.

4) As advertising wizard David Ogilvy observed, *"The heart of a great advertisement is a great big promise."* In the Lady Luck's case, "win or your

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money back" is a big promise. Unlike any competitors' promises. Radical for the industry. Look carefully at your marketing efforts and see whether they feature big, exciting, provocative promises or small, ordinary promises or even no promises at all.

Learning and living by these lessons alone can make a big, positive difference in the success of your marketing efforts.

As we approach the end of one year and the beginning of another, it seems appropriate to call your attention to another fundamental marketing idea, even though it is out of sequence with our Issue-by-Issue progression through a course in marketing. The idea is: clarity of purpose. This is the time of year when we typically take time to reflect on the accomplishments, disappointments and events of the past eleven months and then to look ahead and contemplate, forecast and make resolutions for the twelve months ahead. As you go through this exercise, I urge you to evaluate the relative fogginess and clarity of your marketing objectives and plans from last year and to work for greater clarity for the objectives and plans of your new year.

One of the unique things, I think about my approach to teaching marketing, to doing marketing consulting and to implementing marketing campaigns is that I base it all on proven "success philosophy." For example, I find that the principles enumerated in Napoleon Hill's classic THINK AND GROW RICH, examined in-depth in Foster Hibbard's teachings, and presented in modern, practial form in the new book Foster and I co-authored (Secrets To Guaranteed Goal Achievement) are as relevant to marketing as they are to more general personal and professional success. One of those principles is, of course, "Definiteness Of Purpose." It is a great watchword for making marketing decisions and investments.

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Getting Started in Your Own Small Business (An Edited Excerpt from the Getting Started: A Getting-Into-Business Guide by Dan Kennedy

What To Do When Things Go Wrong

Brace yourself for the tough parts.

You are now just about ready to hang up the sign, print up the business cards, open the doors, and start your new business. Let's take a few minutes to think about the psychological perils that may lie ahead.

One interior designer, who had left a management level position with a large company to start her own business, and was earning three times as much in her new business as in her old job, was still having a rough time dealing with what she described as isolation and loneliness.

"You just don't have the same kinds of relationships as the head of a small business," she said, "as you do one member of a team in a big corporation. And I miss that."

One management lecturer compared starting a business to running a marathon; he counseled his listeners to be in shape physically and emotionally before attempting this feat.

I hear about this matter of stamina from many new enterpreneurs suddenly faced with a continuous stream of insecurities. *Did I make the right decision? Should I have bought that piece of equipment now or waited? How did that meeting go? What should I have done differently?*

"Things I took for granted when I was working for someone else," one executive told me, "suddenly took on mammoth importance when I became self-employed. Before, a meeting with a supplier was just a meeting - good, bad or indifferent. Now I need a good relationship with that supplier. I need to be on his good side. I worry about the meeting ahead of time, and I re-play every minute of it afterward, questioning whether I said the right things. It's very stressful."

Responsibility to others magnifies that stress for many people. Many people tell me they wish they'd started their businesses before they got married and had kids. Some people are held back from starting because of these responsibilities. "It's tough to learn on the job," the owner of a printing business told me, "when you know that a mistake could wipe you out. And Friday, when it's payday, you can't tell the employees: 'Hey, I made a mistake this week. Everybody makes mistakes, right?' "

Time becomes a different issue, too.

An employee may wonder whether he or she can afford to get away for a weekend mini-vacation. But the entrepreneur usually feels he or she can't take the time away from the business, regardless of the finances. A recent study showed that over 50% of all small-business owners work at least 60 hours a week the first year, and 25% work more than 70 hours. And most new business people still tell me they need more time to get things up and running right.

Personally, the biggest adjustment I had to make early in my entrepreneurial career was accepting the fact that business was about solving problems. Frankly, that's still an occasional cause of psychological wear and tear for me. When will the flow of problems stop? The answer is: never. That's business.

These psychological and emotional perils have a lot more to do with the high rate of small business failure than most people realize and most statistical studies take into account. Many people find themselves unable to cope and, subconsciously if not consciously, let their businesses fail in order to escape the stress.

Here are a few tips to help you prepare for and survive the emotional roller coaster of starting a small business:

*** **Identify and honestly accept your strengths and weaknesses.**

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The first book in this Getting-Into-Business Series - **Getting Ready** - is designed to help you with that. By building up your strengths and compensating for your weaknesses, by planned self-improvement and strategic delegation of responsibilities, you will get rid of some of the stress.

*** **Don't become isolated.**

It's easy for the new entrepreneur to become isolated from old friends and associations, as you'll have less and less in common with former co-workers and with "employee mentality" friends with each passing month. Still, some social activity wholly unrelated to your business is necessary for sound mental health. You might set aside one or two evenings a month for getting together with old friends. At the same time, make a point of forming new friendships with business contacts, influential community members, and others you meet through your business.

*** **Keep communication with your spouse and kids open.**

Make sure they understand the risks and pressure you face, so that you have their support. But force yourself to make time just for them in your weekly schedule.

*** **Work at maintaining your perspective.**

Things are rarely as good or as bad as they seem at first glance, and it's important to train yourself not to over-react or to react too quickly. Remember that you are not your business, and not everything that goes on in the business should be taken personally. Insist on one half-hour each day when you stop running, sit down somewhere alone, and just think. Clearing your mind at the end of the day is a good idea, too. You really do have to manage your mind and your emotions.

*** **Be sure to derive pleasure from what you do.**

The greatest stress comes from being in a business just for the money. If you can't find some enjoyment in the journey, you'll never last long enough to get to what you perceive as the destination!

*** **Use resource organizations whenever you can.**

Learning from other successful entrepreneurs who have already traveled the path you're on and belonging to groups of entrepreneurs can diminish the sense of isolation many new business owners feel. You may find these kinds of organizations locally, under ASSOCIATIONS in the Yellow Pages, as local chapters of your trade association, and by asking other business people.

And don't rule out help from the academic community. There's a tendency amoung entrepreneurs to value "street smarts" to the point of completely devaluing information from academic sources. However, a great deal of good research work relevant to small business is done by colleges and universities. Also, an increasing number of colleges, community colleges and high schools are offering courses and/or adult education classes on entrepreneurial topics, conducted by knowledgeable instructors, often with guest lecturers from the business sector. You may find such a program locally, and have an opportunity to learn and associate with other small business owners-to-be and experts.

*** **Take time away from your business, even when you think you can't, to defuse stress, clear your mind, and re-energize.**

Many entrepreneurs never take week-long or two-week-long vacations, like most employees do, but instead grab three-day weekends many times during the year. There are probably tourist attractions and interesting places to visit with a few hours' drive of where you live that you haven't explored. Even a weekend in a good hotel, with a pool, spa, tennis court, etc., a few miles from home can serve as a vacation.

*** **Stay physically fit.**

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Start-up entrepreneurs often completely ignore their health, which only serves to diminish their stamina and ability to handle stress. You don't have to be an "exercise maniac," but most experts agree that, at the very least, an early morning or evening walk or bicycle ride or swim is a very good practice. Living on vending machine junk and coffee is not helpful, either. If you're not going to take time to go out for a decent lunch, pack a brown bag from home.

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BILL GIBSON'S A TOP BUSINESS SPEAKER IN CANADA - HERE ARE A FEW TIPS FROM HIS PRESENTATION TO NSA: "HOW TO BOOST YOUR BUSINESS IN ANY ECONOMY"

#4: Amplifying & Magnifying People, Products and Events.... find ways to magnify the popularity and image of a special person, group, etc. through an image-making strategy in order to create/expand market demand for related products or services.

#5: Capitalizing On A Growth Trend....offer products and services to an industry or market where there is growth!

#8: Second-Try Situations....find a good product or service that has failed for a variety of reasons in the past and devise a new strategy to make it succeed.*

#9: Catering To Left-Behind Markets....cater to markets left behind by companies for reasons like: companies have become so large they do not want to handle small orders; companies are competing on the leading edge of a technology and have decided not to service markets based on older technology, etc.

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*Dan's Note re. #8 - read "Getting It Right The Second Time" by Michael Gershman/Published by Addison-Wesley. (Did you know...Pepsi went bankrupt 3 times!....Raytheon LOST 5 Million bucks on the first Microwave Oven....vacuum cleaners, liquid soap, Cracker Jack all FAILED. There are 6 secrets" of RE-Marketing presented in this great book.)

RECOMMENDED READING: A recent survey of top DM'ers by DM NEWS reveals their most-read books to be David Oglivy On Advertising and his Confessions Of An Advertising Man. I often quote Oglivy in my seminars as the "spotted owl of advertising"....THAT rare!.....because, while building the world's largest Ad Agency, he continually chastised his industry and his own people for producing advertising that does everything but sell. His insights into what advertising should be are priceless.

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WHAT'S ON THEIR MINDS?

According to a DDB Neeham commisioned study, 60% of the people "would do things differently if they had their lives to live over again" and a "fear of the future" has risen from 10% in 1989 to 29% now.

The most interesting thing about this study, though, is the difference between how people in the advertising agencies thought the public would respond and how the public did respond - egs:

1) "I want to look different from others." Ad folks' guess: 89%. Reality 62%.

2) "There is too much sex on prime time TV." Addies' guess: 50%. Public: 78%.

3) "There should be a gun in every house." Addies' guess: 9%. Public: 32%.

4) "TV is my primary form of entertainment." Addies' guess: 28%. Public: 53%.

5) "My favorite music is easy listening." Addies' guess: 27%. Public: 51%.
"My favorite music is classic rock." Addies' guess: 64%. Public 35%.

One ad exec admitted: I have met the customer and he ain't me." NEVER FORGET THIS LESSON! You are not your market. You are definitely not reflective of the public market. Your likes, dislikes, fears, desires, preferences, are not to be ignored but are never to be used as predictions of marketplace reaction either.